

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 3

♥ 10 4

♦ K Q 10 9 6 2

♣ 10 8 6 2

♠ A 8

♥ K Q 9 7 2

♦ 8 7 4

♣ Q J 3



♠ 9 6 4 2

♥ 5

♦ J 5 3

♣ A K 9 7 4

♠ K Q J 10 7 5

♥ A J 8 6 3

♦ A

♣ 5

Since there has not been a clear agreement on the trump suit you can assume it is ♥s, the last bid suit.

So you have two Key-Cards (♠A and ♥K, along with the ♥Q). You therefore bid 5♠ and partner bids 6♥.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

1♠

Pass

5♠

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6♥

6♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A Q J 3

♦ Q 6

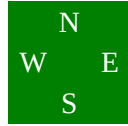
♣ K Q J

♠ 6 4

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 10 7 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3



♠ A 10 9 7 3 2

♥ K 9 5

♦ 8 5

♣ A 7

♠ 8

♥ 10 7 4

♦ A K J 9

♣ 9 8 6 5 2

West

1 ♣

4 ♠

5 ♥

All Pass

5 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ K

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

5 ♣

5 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

Partner's jump to 4 ♠ indicates he is prepared to play at game even if you have as few as 6 points. So he must have 20 points or so. With your 14 that puts you in slam range.

Despite your conviction that this hand is going to slam you should **NOT** ask for Key-Cards holding a worthless doubleton. Instead, you make a slam try by bidding your cheapest control, 5 ♣. Partner says 5 ♥. What is your next bid?

You can only say 5 ♠. Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he held the Ace since controls are bid up-the-line. His failure to show it means he doesn't have it. Since you might be off the first two ♦ tricks you stop at 5 ♠.

Yes, partner should probably have opened 2NT. Sometimes partners don't make the bids you think they oughta.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 10 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 4
♣ J 9 6 5

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ A 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A 8 2



♠ A 4

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 9 6 2

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ 5

♣ K Q 3

You have 3 Key-Cards so you bid 5♦. Partner bids
6♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♥2

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 7 2
 ♥ K Q 5
 ♦ K 5
 ♣ A K 6

♠ 10 6

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 10 9 8 7 4

♣ 7 5 4



♠ K Q 8 4
 ♥ A J 6
 ♦ J 3
 ♣ Q J 8 3

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 9 8 2

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ 10 9 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	4 ♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5 ♠	Pass
6 ♠			
All Pass			
6 ♠ by West			
Lead: ♣4			

Your partnership plays Jacoby 2NT convention, so partner's 2NT shows a game-forcing raise in ♠s. Your 3NT bid indicates a 5-card suit and "extra values". Partner's 4♥ is a control-bid showing the ♥A.

What you need to know now about partner's hand is Key-Cards so you bid 4NT. He answers 5♠. What is your bid?

Partner's response says 2 Key-Cards and the ♠Q. So you are missing either the trump King or the ♦A. So you shouldn't bid 7, but you will almost surely make 6. You bid 6♠.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6



♠ 8 6 2

♥ K J 8 5 3 2

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			
6♦ by North			
Lead: ♣8			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

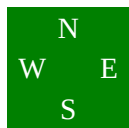
♠ A 6 5 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ K J 3
♣ 8 2

♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3



♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ -

♣ A K Q 7

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♠ 7			

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠ A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠ A or the practically useless ♦ A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠ A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.